



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Market Planning

FOOD MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of marketing plans.
2. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
3. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
4. Explain the concept of product mix.
5. Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Marketing Manager for FRESH FIELDS MARKET, a regional grocery store chain known for high-quality organic produce. The Director of Merchandising (judge) wants you to develop a marketing plan for a new private-label product line created to combat food waste.

FRESH FIELDS MARKET prides itself on visual perfection in its produce department. However, this strict standard results in a significant amount of "imperfect" fruits and vegetables (items that are bruised, misshapen, or the wrong size) being discarded, despite being perfectly safe and nutritious to eat.

To reduce waste and increase revenue, the company is launching a new private-label line of shelf-stable products called "The Imperfect Batch." This product line will include jarred salsas, fruit jams, and vegetable soups made entirely from the "ugly" produce that would otherwise be thrown away.

The Director of Merchandising (judge) is concerned that customers might view these products as low-quality because they are made from "discarded" ingredients. The Director (judge) wants you to create a marketing plan that positions "The Imperfect Batch" as a premium, eco-friendly choice rather than a discount "leftover" product.

The Director (judge) wants you to present a plan that includes:

- Primary Target Market: Who is most likely to buy upcycled food products?
- Product Positioning: How to communicate the quality and safety of the ingredients.
- Marketing Strategies: Specific ways to promote the line inside the store and online.
- Competitive Advantage: Why this line is better than national brands of salsa or jam.

You will present your ideas to the Director of Merchandising (judge) in a role-play to take place in the Director's office. The Director (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How can we use in-store sampling to prove the quality of the product to hesitant customers?
2. Should we choose a pricing strategy that is cheaper than national brands or priced the same?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of marketing plans?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the concept of market and market identification?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the concept of marketing strategies?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain the concept of product mix?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify product's/service's competitive advantage?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						